



Fig. 4: A 24-hour cloud forecast loop from LAPS using MM5 as the forecast model (Source: www.laps.fsl.noaa.gov)

first set performs weather-related calculations used in forecasting, while the other set is continuously looking for ways to improve the supercomputer's software, thereby making weather predictions more accurate and meticulous.

TriNet is a five-year-old collaborative project focused on producing a better, more effective, real-time earthquake-information system for southern California, USA. A high-tech system developed by TriNet has the capability to provide instantaneous damage reports for emergency relief in certain areas of greater Los Angeles area (USA). At its core, TriNet system consists of a broad array of earthquake sensors linked to computers. When an earthquake occurs, seismographs automatically record and transmit data to a computer at California Institute of Technology. The computer synthesises a shake map from the entire ground-motion data, which immediately informs emergency managers about the worst-shaken location. Emergency relief can then first be provided to the most severely affected areas. The shake map also indicates where the ground did not shake, thus enabling emergency crews to establish relief shelters and hospitals in areas near destruction points.

IBM's Deep Thunder

Deep Thunder is a research project by IBM that aspires to develop short-term local weather forecasting using high-performance computing. The project belongs to the same family as Deep Blue system that beat world chess champion Garry Kasparov in May 1997. It uses information gathered by NWS but focuses on much smaller geographic areas than NWS and that too in greater detail.

Deep Thunder takes data and puts it through a numerical model, which predicts the weather. It works

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